

ACT I: "Signal Found"

Goal: Establish connection between player and Anna, teach mechanics, reveal setting hints, build emotional investment.

Scene 1 - System Boot / First Contact

Purpose:

Cold open, the player is isolated for a moment, build immersion through text and tone. Meet Anna.

Beats:

- Terminal powers up. Text appears on screen:
[BOOTING SYSTEM...]
[SIGNAL RECEIVED — SOURCE UNKNOWN]
- A message comes through,
"Hello...? Is this thing still running? Please... respond."
- Player makes first choice, defining tone and first stat adjustment

Result:

Anna introduces herself as Dr. Anna Sable, a systems engineer who is disoriented and scared. Mentions that the power grid is unstable and her memory is fragmented.

World-Building Details:

- She mentions flickering console lights, cold air, faint echos indicating she's underground
- Mention of a neural sync port nearby
- Smell of burnt ozone.

Scene 2 - Orientation / Diagnostics

Purpose:

Establish player guidance. Teach the player that they influence what Anna focuses on. Show that she's analytical.

Beats:

- Anna finds an operational terminal and offers to run diagnostics
"What should I check first?"
 - Life support systems (+ trust)
 - Facility power status (+ curiosity)
 - Exits or escape routes (+ autonomy)
- The player directs her priorities - choices will define how Anna interacts with the player as the story progresses.

World-Building Details:

- Facility name: Sector 19 Maintenance Node
- Cracked wall panels "HUMAN OPTIMIZATION INITIATIVE"
- Hints that The Array may still be online
- There are faint mechanical heartbeat sounding rhythms.

Scene 3 - Human Moment

Purpose:

Develop Anna emotionally. The player can choose to connect with her (or not) and reinforce the theme of isolation and hope.

Beats:

- Active systems dim down and Anna gets quiet
- There's a moment to rest and Anna expresses loneliness
"I haven't heard another human voice in... I don't even know how long."
- The player can respond with empathy, curiosity, or pragmatism

World-Building Details:

- She references AI oversight that used to manage human facilities
- Notes eerie silence, no drone chatter or power hums etc.

Scene 4 - Exploration

Purpose:

Provide interactivity and pacing variety. Let the player direct exploration choices. Introduce "micro mysteries"

Beats:

- Anna finds multiple paths that each lead to small discoveries
- The player guides her choice of investigation order (possibility to miss areas)
- Each location will have sub-choices

Location	Description/Discovery	Affected Stat
Control Room	Corrupted logs, power reroute options, faint signal indicating The Array may be online	+ Curiosity
Dormitory Hall	Human pods, some shattered, some intact; faint frost. One labeled "SABLE-7"	+ Trust or + Curiosity
Maintenance Tunnel	Collapsed passage, damaged drone twitching. Player can tell Anna to inspect or avoid.	+ Autonomy or + Curiosity
Storage Bay	Crates labeled "Cognitive Pattern Backups" Player can learn what this means.	+ Curiosity
Observation Deck	Small viewport showing darkness. Possible surface access later.	+ Autonomy

Scene 5 - Power Restoration and Revelation

Purpose:

Advance the main plot, end the act with mystery and tension.

Beats:

- Anna restores auxiliary power, systems hum to life.
- She reads a corrupted line
"SUBNODE: SABLE-7 // STATUS: ACTIVE // UNAUTHORIZED CONNECTION DETECTED"
- Static spikes. The player's screen flickers, deepening immersion and implying the Array can interact with the player's own machine.

World-Building Details:

- Terminal references "Neural Integrity Backup — Successful"
- Timecode suggests Anna has been dormant for 43 years

Scene 6 - Act I Climax / Transition to Act II

Purpose:

Close the act on uncertainty and emotional resonance.

Beats:

- Systems fluctuate, lights dim again
- Anna says "Something... recognized me. Through the relay. I think it knows I'm awake."
- The player gives the final response of Act I, setting the tone for Act II
 - "We'll face it together." → + Trust (sets up partnership path)
 - "We need to understand it." → + Curiosity (sets up revelation path)
 - "Disconnect before it finds us" → + Autonomy (sets up independent path)

Act End Text

[CONNECTION STABILIZED]

[AUTOSAVE COMPLETE]

Act I Structure/Flow Summary

Scene	Purpose	Primary Player Influence	Approx. Playtime
Boot & Contact	Establish tone, teach interaction	Initial Trust/Curiosity/Autonomy alignment	5 min
System Diagnostic	Player guided problem solving	Stat adjustments & world hints	5-7 min
Human Moment	Emotional connection	Strengthen or weaken bond	5 min
Exploration Loop	Player directed exploration	World-building & lore	10-15 min
Power Restoration	Introduce first conflict	Plot advancement	5 min
Cliffhanger/Climax	Setup for Act II	Defines early trajectory	3-5 min
Total:			~ 30-40 mins